SPOUSE LEDGER

The Complete Business & Household Continuity Worksheet
for Entrepreneurial Couples

Everything your spouse would need to keep the business and the household running if something happened to you: the accounts, the bills, the people, the plans, and the things only you know how to do.

Owner Name:

Business Name(s):

Spouse / Successor Name:

Date Started:
Set a reminder to review every 6 months

Not legal, tax, insurance, investment, or financial advice. See the full notice on page 2.

START • SECTION 0

Start Here

Read this page first.

If something has just happened:

[ ] Breathe. Almost nothing on this list has to be decided this week. Don't rush any big decision.

[ ] Turn to **Section 14 (First 30 Days)** and work through it in order.

[ ] Call the people in **Section 1**, starting with the attorney and the CPA.

[ ] Check what cash is available and what bills hit in the next 30 days (**Sections 2 and 6**).

[ ] Do NOT cancel insurance, licenses, utilities, or subscriptions until you've checked with the attorney or CPA.

[ ] Do NOT make promises to employees, crews, or clients yet.

How this worksheet is organized

Part 1: The Business (Sections 1-5): contacts, money, operations, people, and the exit plan.
Part 2: Home & Family (Sections 6-13): household money, insurance, legal documents, taxes, investments, property, family, and digital life.
Section 14: the First 30 Days checklist and a personal letter.

How to fill it in

Fill in what you can. Leave a blank rather than guess, because an honest gap is safer than wrong information. For accounts, write the institution and the **last 4 digits only**. **Never write full account numbers or passwords in this book.** Those belong in your password manager and the sealed emergency envelope (Section 13). Pages that say "where it lives" want a location, such as a drawer, a folder, or an app, not the document itself.

Important: please read. *Spouse Ledger is a personal record-keeping and organizing tool. It is not legal, tax, accounting, insurance, investment, or financial advice, and using it does not create an attorney-client, accountant-client, or advisory relationship. Laws, deadlines, and institutional rules vary by state and change over time.*
Writing a wish or instruction in this book does not make it legally binding or give anyone authority over an account, asset, or business. That generally requires properly executed legal documents (such as a will, trust, power of attorney, or beneficiary designation) and the cooperation of the institution involved.
Before making decisions about estates, trusts, guardianship, beneficiaries, taxes, insurance claims, investments or retirement accounts, or the sale, transfer, or wind-down of a business, consult licensed professionals: an attorney, a CPA or tax professional, an insurance agent, and, where relevant, a financial advisor or business broker.
Spouse Ledger and its creators make no guarantee that the information recorded here is accurate, complete, or current, and assume no liability for decisions made in reliance on it. Keep this book secure, and do not record passwords, full account numbers, or recovery phrases in it.

Completion Tracker

Date each section when it's filled in. Re-date when you review it.

Section	Completed	Last reviewed	Next review
1. Who to Call			
2. Business Money			
3. How the Business Runs			
4. The People			
5. Business Exit Plan			
6. Household Money & Bills			
7. Insurance & Protection			
8. Legal & Estate			
9. Taxes			
10. Investments & Retirement			
11. Property & Valuables			
12. Family & Dependents			
13. Digital Life & Secure Access			
14. First 30 Days & Letter			
Emergency envelope sealed & stored			

PART 1 • SECTION 1

Who to Call

One card per person. Business contacts first, then personal and family.

Business

CPA / Accountant

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Business Attorney

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Business Insurance Agent (incl. key-person)

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Banker / Business Banking Rep

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Bookkeeper

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Payroll Provider

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Bonding / Surety Agent (if applicable)

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Key Employee / Crew Lead #1

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Key Subcontractor / Crew #1

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Key Subcontractor / Crew #2

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Key Client / Referral Source

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Trusted Peer in the Trade (could advise on running or selling)

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Personal & Family

Personal / Estate Attorney

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Financial Advisor / Planner

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Personal Insurance Agent (life, auto, home)

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Mortgage Servicer / Lender

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Primary Care Doctor (adult)

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Family Member Who Can Help #1

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Family Member Who Can Help #2

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Trusted Friend / Faith Leader / Mentor

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Neighbor with a Spare Key

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

Funeral Home or Arrangements Contact (if decided)

Name / Firm: _____ **Phone:** _____

Email: _____ **Notes:** _____

PART 1 • SECTION 2

Business Money

Identifying info only: last 4 digits, never full numbers or passwords.

Business Bank Accounts

Bank	Type (operating, payroll, tax, savings)	Last 4	Who can sign?	Purpose / notes

Business Credit Cards & Lines of Credit

Issuer	Last 4	Limit	Who's authorized?	What it's used for

Business Loans & Equipment Financing

Lender	What it financed	Balance (approx.)	Monthly pmt	Due date	Contact

Recurring Business Bills

Software, insurance, lease/rent, equipment, phones, fuel cards, memberships.

Vendor	What for	Amount	Due date	Paid from / autopay?

Merchant Services / Payment Processor

Square, Stripe, bank card processing: where deposits land

Payroll Provider & Schedule

Who runs it, which day, which account funds it, who approves

Money Owed TO the Business (receivables)

Where the list lives, who tracks it, insurance carrier payments pending

Money the Business Owes OUT (payables)

Where the list lives, supplier accounts, open material orders

Where the Books Are Kept

Software name, who has access, bookkeeper contact

PART 1 • SECTION 3

How the Business Actually Runs

The knowledge that keeps it alive, not just the paperwork.

What This Business Does, Day to Day

In plain language, as if explaining to someone with zero context

Active Jobs / Contracts in Progress

Where the current list lives, how to check status, who the customers' main contacts are

Licenses / Certifications Required to Operate

Who holds them. Critical if it's YOUR personal license keeping the business legal. Renewal dates

Bonding / Business Insurance Required to Operate

Key Vendors / Suppliers Relied On Weekly

Name, what they supply, account contact, credit terms

Equipment / Vehicles / Trailers Owned or Leased

What, where it is, lender or lease status, where keys and titles are

Physical Locations

Shop, storage, office: address, who has keys, lease or owned, landlord contact

Seasonal or Timing-Sensitive Facts

e.g. "storm season starts in spring," "insurance renews every March"

Recurring Customer / Insurance-Carrier Relationships

Who matters most, what's pending, anything a spouse should never promise

Business Systems & Accounts: Index Only

List WHAT exists (accounting, CRM/job software, email, website/domain host, Google Business, social, phone system, e-sign). Passwords go in the vault, NOT here

Things Only I Know How to Do in the Business

Estimating, submitting claims, scheduling crews, ordering materials, running payroll: where each is documented

PART 1 • SECTION 4

The People Who Work Here

Employees, subcontractors, and who could step up.

Employees (W-2)

Name	Role	Phone	Pay / schedule	Notes (reliable? knows the systems?)

Subcontractors / Crews

Name / Company	What they do	Phone	How paid	Notes

Who Could Run Day-to-Day Operations Temporarily?

Name, and have they actually agreed? Who would you trust to advise your spouse?

Who Has Keys / Access / Admin Rights to What

Shop, vehicles, storage, safe, software admin, bank signers, company cards

Who Should Your Spouse NOT Rely On or Be Careful With?

Honest notes: anyone who could take advantage, owes money, or isn't dependable

Employee / Crew Commitments in Flight

Promised raises, bonuses, referral fees, pending commissions, advances

PART 1 • SECTION 5

Business Exit Plan: If Something Happens

Disclaimer: *This section records your plans and where things are. It is not legal, tax, or financial advice. Before deciding anything about selling, transferring, valuing, or winding down the business, including acting on a buy-sell agreement, key-person insurance, an operating agreement, or a broker's or buyer's offer, consult a licensed business attorney and, where relevant, a CPA and a qualified business broker. Do not sign anything from a prospective buyer or broker until your own attorney has reviewed it.*

Business Entity Type & Where Documents Are Kept

LLC / S-corp / sole prop; articles, operating agreement, EIN letter, annual report filings

Buy-Sell Agreement?

Exists? Where is it, who holds a copy, who is the other party

Key-Person Life Insurance on Me?

Carrier, policy last 4, who is the beneficiary (business or spouse), approximate payout, agent

Named Successor / Decision-Maker

And do they know it? Does the operating agreement say who takes over?

Is Anything Titled Only in My Name?

Business accounts, vehicles, licenses, domains that may need legal steps before my spouse can use them. Ask the attorney

Spouse's Intent (optional, in your own words)

Keep running it, sell it, wind it down, not sure yet. It's fine to change your mind

If Selling

Any valuation on file, interested buyers, business broker contact, what I'd consider a fair price range

If Winding Down

Open jobs to finish or hand off, warranties outstanding, equipment to sell, licenses to close

What NOT to Do Immediately

Don't cancel insurance, let licenses lapse, sign anything from a buyer, or promise employees anything yet

PART 2: HOME & FAMILY • SECTION 6

Household Money & Bills

Last 4 digits only. Where the money is, what's owed, and what has to be paid every month.

Personal Bank Accounts

Checking, savings, joint, individual, kids' accounts. Mark who is on each one.

Bank	Type	Last 4	In whose name? (joint / mine / hers)	Purpose

Accounts ONLY in My Name

These may be frozen or need legal steps before my spouse can touch them. Ask the bank or attorney now, and consider adding my spouse

Emergency Cash: How Much and Where

Cash on hand, emergency fund, anything my spouse can reach immediately

Home: Mortgage / Rent / HELOC

Lender / Landlord	Type	Loan # (last 4)	Balance (approx.)	Monthly pmt	Due	Taxes & ins. escrowed?

Vehicle Loans & Other Personal Loans (student, personal, family, medical)

Lender	What it's for	Last 4	Balance (approx.)	Monthly pmt	Due

Personal Credit Cards

Issuer	Last 4	Whose name?	Autopay?	Balance (approx.)	Notes

Personal Guarantees & Co-Signed Debt

Anything I personally guaranteed for the business (loans, leases, credit lines, supplier accounts) or co-signed for others. Spouse must know these exist

Monthly Bill Calendar: Home & Personal

Utilities, phones, subscriptions, tuition, childcare, HOA. Every bill that has to keep getting paid.

Bill	Company / account #	Amount	Due	Paid from / autopay?
Electric				
Water / Sewer				
Gas / Propane				
Trash / Recycling				
Internet / Cable				
Cell Phones				
Home Security / Alarm				
HOA / Dues				
Streaming / Subscriptions				
Childcare / Tuition				
Church / Charity / Gym				
Lawn / Pest / Pool				

How the Bills Actually Get Paid

Which account pays what, what's on autopay, what I pay by hand each month and when

Household Income Sources

Owner draws/distributions (how and when), spouse's income, rental income, anything else. What happens to cash flow if the business pauses?

Money Owed to Us Personally

Loans to family or friends, deposits, pending refunds or settlements

Where Household Financial Records Live

Folder, cabinet, software (Quicken, spreadsheet, budgeting app), bank statements, receipts

Insurance & Protection

Every policy, who covers what, and who gets paid. Policy # last 4 only.

Disclaimer: *Policy terms, exclusions, and claim deadlines are set by each insurer's contract, not by this worksheet. Beneficiary designations on file with the carrier generally control who is paid, regardless of what a will says. Confirm coverage, premiums, and beneficiaries with your agent or carrier.*

Policies

Type	Carrier	Policy # (last 4)	Coverage / amount	Premium & due date	Agent / phone
Life: personal					
Life: key-person (business)					
Disability: personal					
Health					
Dental / Vision					
Auto					
Homeowners / Renters					
Umbrella / Excess liability					
General liability (business)					
Workers' compensation					
Commercial auto / equipment					
Cyber / Professional liability					
Other:					

Beneficiaries Named on Each Life Policy & Date Last Verified

Out-of-date beneficiaries (old names, no contingent) are a common, costly mistake. Check them every year

Where the Actual Policies Are Kept

Drawer, safe, fireproof box, agent's office, online portal

Employer / Group Benefits (mine or my spouse's)

Group life, disability, health continuation: who to call at the employer or HR

Legal & Estate Documents

Where the originals are, who is named, and who knows.

Disclaimer: *Recording where your estate documents are, and what you want, does not replace having them properly drafted and signed. Wills, trusts, powers of attorney, healthcare directives, and guardian nominations must follow your state's legal requirements to be valid. Wishes written in this book, including funeral wishes and the letter, are generally not legally binding. Ask your estate attorney to confirm that your documents, beneficiary designations, and account titling all agree.*

Will

Exists? Date signed, where the ORIGINAL is, who the executor / personal representative is, attorney who drafted it

Trust(s)

Name of trust, trustee, successor trustee, what is held in it, where the documents are

Durable Power of Attorney (financial)

Who is named as agent, where the signed original is

Healthcare Directive / Medical Power of Attorney / HIPAA Release

Who is named, where the copies are, which doctor and hospital have a copy

Guardianship for Minor Children

Who is named as guardian in the will, do they know, and have they agreed?

Prenuptial / Postnuptial Agreements, Divorce Decrees, Support Orders

Where they are, anything that affects ownership, support or custody

Beneficiary Designations Outside the Will

Retirement accounts, life insurance, payable-on-death / transfer-on-death accounts: confirm they match your wishes

Funeral, Burial & Memorial Wishes

Cemetery plot, prepaid arrangements, preferences, who should speak, what you do and don't want

Organ Donation / Special Instructions

Pending Legal Matters

Lawsuits, liens, claims, disputes, contracts under negotiation, anything with a deadline

Safe Deposit Box / Where Original Documents Are Kept

Bank and box location, who is authorized, where the key is. Birth certificates, marriage license, passports, SS cards, titles, deeds

Taxes

Deadlines and obligations that don't stop when you do.

Disclaimer: *Tax rules, deadlines, and penalties vary by jurisdiction and change often. Unpaid payroll taxes can create personal liability. Confirm every obligation and due date with your CPA or tax professional, and call them before changing, skipping, or catching up on any filing or payment.*

Tax Preparer / CPA

Name, phone, and whether they prepare both personal and business returns

Where the Last 7 Years of Returns Are Kept

Personal and business, paper and digital

Quarterly Estimated Tax Payments

Federal and state: due dates, usual amounts, which account pays, how it's submitted

Payroll Tax Deposits & Filings

Who handles them, schedule, which agency accounts exist. Missed payroll taxes can create personal liability, so call the CPA first

Sales / Use Tax, Business Licenses, Annual Reports, Registered Agent

Filing dates, renewal fees, where each is filed

Property Taxes

Parcels, amounts, due dates, escrowed or paid directly

Open Tax Notices, Audits, or Payment Plans

Agency, what it's about, deadlines, who is handling it

Investments & Retirement

Everything that has value but isn't a checking account.

Disclaimer: *This worksheet records where assets are. It does not recommend any investment or action. Account ownership, beneficiary designations, and each custodian's rules determine who can access an asset and what steps are required. Digital assets such as cryptocurrency may be permanently unrecoverable without the keys or recovery phrases. Store those securely, never in this book.*

Investment & Retirement Accounts

Institution	Account type (401k, IRA, brokerage, HSA, 529...)	Last 4	In whose name?	Beneficiary named?

Business Retirement Plan (Solo 401k, SEP, SIMPLE)

Provider, plan administrator, who can act on it

Cryptocurrency / Digital Assets

Which exchanges or wallets. Where a hardware wallet is. Where recovery phrases are stored (NOT written here). Without these, the funds are lost

Pensions, Annuities, Social Security Info

Where statements are, who to contact

Ownership in Other Businesses or Partnerships

Other LLCs, real estate partnerships, stock options, partners' contact info

Property & Valuables

What you own, where it is, and how to get into it.

Real Estate

Address	Titled to	Mortgage? (lender)	Deed / title location	Notes (rental? for sale?)

Vehicles, Trailers, Boats, Equipment

Description	Titled to	Lender / lease	Title location	Where it's kept / keys

Home Safe / Lockbox

Where it is, where the combination or key is kept (not the combo itself)

Valuables, Collectibles, Jewelry, Firearms & Where They Are

Include any registered or licensed items and who should handle them

Storage Units / Other Locations

Address, unit #, who pays, how to access

House Shutoffs & Systems

Water main, breaker panel, gas shutoff, HVAC, sprinkler, septic, generator, alarm panel: where each is

Home Maintenance & Trusted Service People

HVAC, plumber, electrician, lawn, handyman, roofer, pest, with phone numbers

Warranties, Manuals, Receipts for Big Purchases

Where kept

Intellectual Property & Brand Assets

Trademarks, domains (registrar), logos, websites, customer lists, where they live and who owns them

Family & Dependents

The people, routines, and responsibilities that depend on you.

Children

Name	School / grade	Doctor / dentist	Allergies, meds, special needs	Activities, coaches, pickup

Childcare, After-School, and Carpool Arrangements

Who, when, how they're paid, who can pick up, who is on the school's authorized-pickup list

Co-Parenting / Custody Arrangements (if any)

Aging Parents or Other Dependents I Help Support

Who, what they need, who else is involved, payments I make

Pets

Names, vet, medications, microchip info, who could take them

My Spouse's Own Situation

Their work, income, benefits, health coverage, and anything they'd need to set up (their own accounts, cards, access)

People Who Will Want to Help (and What They're Good At)

Family, friends, neighbors, church: who to ask for meals, childcare, rides, paperwork, a listening ear

Tasks ONLY I Handle

Everything that quietly gets done because I do it: bills, taxes, renewals, maintenance, school forms, vehicle registrations, filters, annual fees.

Task	How often	Where / how it's done	Notes

Digital Life & Secure Access

Write WHERE things are. Never write actual passwords or recovery phrases on these pages.

Recommended: use a password manager with emergency access (1Password or Bitwarden). Set an emergency passcode your spouse knows, write it on paper, and seal it in an envelope stored where your spouse will find it. A phone passcode, an authenticator app, and a primary email can each lock someone out of everything else, so cover them first.

Password Manager Used & Emergency Access Set Up?

Where the Sealed Emergency Envelope Is Kept
Should contain the emergency passcode and master-account recovery info

Phone & Device Unlock
Who knows my phone passcode? Does my spouse have it? Other devices: laptop, tablet, home computer

Two-Factor Authentication: Where Codes Come From
Authenticator app on my phone, texts to my number, hardware key. Where backup / recovery codes are stored

Primary Email Accounts
Personal and business. Most resets go through these, so my spouse needs a path in

Cell Phone Carrier Account

Whose name, account PIN location, can my spouse manage the lines? The number is also used for 2FA texts

Cloud Storage, Photos, Documents

iCloud / Google / Dropbox: which account, whose, where family photos are backed up

Online Accounts Index (names only)

Banks, utilities, government portals (IRS, SSA, state), payroll, merchant services, supplier portals, insurance portals

Social Media & Business Pages

Facebook business page, Google Business Profile, Instagram, YouTube: who is the admin, who else has access

Website, Domain, Business Email Hosting

Registrar, host, renewal dates, who has the admin login

Digital Executor / Who Should Handle My Accounts

Who is trusted to close, memorialize, or take over accounts

First 30 Days Checklist

Work through this in order. Check each box as you go. Ask the attorney before acting on anything legal or financial.

First few days

[ ] Lean on the people in Section 1 and Section 12. Accept help.

[ ] Contact the funeral home or arrangements contact. Ask them how many certified death certificates to order; many offices need originals.

[ ] Call the attorney (Section 1) and find the will / trust (Section 8).

[ ] Call the CPA and bookkeeper. Review cash and the next 30 days of payroll and bills.

[ ] Call the insurance agent. Ask about life, key-person, health continuation, and anything with a claim deadline.

[ ] Locate the sealed emergency envelope (Section 13) and get into the password manager.

[ ] Tell key employees and crew leads calmly: jobs and paychecks will continue. Keep it short, and don't promise anything long-term.

First two weeks

[ ] File life insurance claims. Ask each carrier what they need.

[ ] Notify Social Security (the funeral home often does this) and any pension or annuity providers.

[ ] Contact the mortgage servicer and other lenders. Ask about next steps and don't skip payments.

[ ] Visit the banks with death certificates. Ask what is frozen and what is available (Section 6).

[ ] Make sure autopay is working for essential bills: utilities, mortgage, insurance, payroll, taxes.

[ ] Review Section 5 with the attorney before any decision on the business.

First 30 days

[ ] Notify the three credit bureaus to flag the account and prevent identity theft.

[ ] Update titles, beneficiaries, and account ownership with the attorney's guidance.

[ ] Handle phones, email, and subscriptions. Close or take over accounts after confirming nothing is needed (Section 13).

[ ] Tell the school, the pediatrician, and the childcare providers what has changed.

[ ] Schedule time with the CPA to cover quarterly tax payments and payroll tax filings.

[ ] Make a plan for the business with the attorney and the person in Section 4: keep, sell, or wind down.

[ ] Give yourself permission to rest. Nothing here has to be perfect.

A LETTER

Letter to My Spouse

Write this by hand. It may be the most important page in the book.

What I want you to know about our finances and the business

What I'd want for the business (keep it, sell it, who to trust)

What I'd want for our family and for the kids

What I'd want you to do for yourself

Anything else

Annual Review Log

Review at least twice a year, and after any big change: a new loan, a new baby, a move, a new employee, a policy renewal.

Date reviewed	What changed	Reviewed by